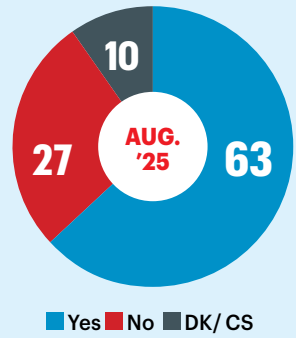


YESTERDAY NO MORE PM Narendra Modi with Donald Trump at the White House, Feb. 13, 2025

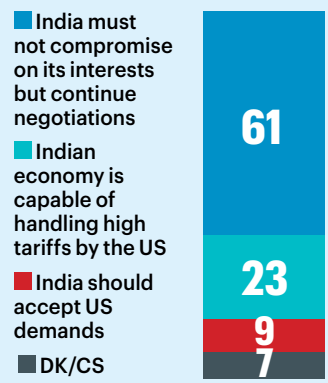
AFP

Q. Are you worried about US president Trump's high tariffs on Indian goods?



Indian exports worth $48.2 billion are affected by US tariffs. Naturally, it worries the majority

Q. How do you think India should deal with the US to ensure tariffs are lowered?



Over 60 per cent of those surveyed are in favour of continued talks

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

I

In the realm of foreign policy, India had an eventful half-year that may well reshape its future course. The first inflection point came in May, when the government launched Operation Sindoor in response to the Pahalgam terrorist attack, accompanied by a carefully calibrated diplomatic effort to rally international support. Soon after came a far more unpredictable variable: a sledgehammer called Donald Trump.

Jeopardising the India-US strategic partnership is Trump's characteristically unilateral move to slap a 25 per cent tariff on imports from India, citing its unjustifiably high tariff regime. More damaging still was an additional 25 per cent penalty on Indian goods, ostensibly in retaliation for New Delhi's continued purchases of discounted Russian oil, bringing the total tariff burden to a bruising 50 per cent. This economic broadside has done more than rattle markets; it has imperilled India's delicate balancing act between its historical ties with Moscow and its growing strategic alignment with Washington. Adding to New Delhi's anxieties is Trump's abrupt diplomatic courtship of Pakistan, rekindling fears of a regional encirclement as relations with China remain tense and Bangladesh drifts away from India's orbit.

74 PER CENT

respondents in the North are opposed to playing sports with Pakistan as it continues to sponsor terrorism, but 38 per cent in the South are okay with it

The US tariffs affect Indian exports worth $48.2 billion (Rs 4.13 lakh crore), with sectors such as textiles, pharmaceuticals, auto components, steel and aluminium bearing the brunt. The textile industry, in particular, may see a sharp fall in orders, with American buyers scouting alternatives in Vietnam and Bangladesh, bringing with it the spectre of job losses and a slowdown in export growth. Though the government has said it will take necessary steps to protect national interests and shield exporters, it has done little to assuage the worries of ordinary Indians. Ac-